



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Oaks Classical Academy
School Website: <https://oaksclassicalacademy.com>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Oaks Classical Academy CA 92009 presents a clearly Christian orientation coupled with a stated aim of delivering a classical liberal arts education. Public materials on the site emphasize Christ-centered education and aims to cultivate discernment of truth, goodness, and beauty, which aligns with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose & Goal elements of classical education. However, explicit, public evidence of core classical curriculum details (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; a full Trivium/Quadrivium structure) and robust Socratic pedagogy is not clearly documented in the school's public materials. Taken together, the school demonstrates foundational classical aspirations and a Christian frame but falls short on several explicit classical markers in its public-facing curriculum and pedagogy disclosures. As a result, the overall classification is **NOT CLASSICAL**, with notable pockets of **CLASSICAL** alignment and a few areas that would be required to move toward a full Classical model.

Key signals from public materials:

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: Strong Christian framing (Christ-centered, rooted in Christ; truth, goodness, beauty), which aligns with transcendental aims when paired with theology-oriented schooling. See Our Mission and Deep Hope statements.
- School Purpose & Goal: Emphasis on formation, discernment of truth/goodness/beauty, and virtue-oriented aims in a Christian context.
- Curriculum: Public materials consistently describe a "classical liberal arts education," but do not publicly enumerate the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or explicit language instruction in grammar/logic/rhetoric on the site excerpts provided. This yields a **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** orientation rather than a full Classical curriculum claim.
- Pedagogy: No explicit reference in the public materials to Socratic seminar, scholé, chanting, or other classical pedagogy elements; the absence points toward **NOT CLASSICAL** pedagogy in public-facing content as presented.
- Faculty: Public materials show standard "faculty & staff" listings but do not publicly describe a living-curriculum model or mentor-style pedagogy on the site excerpts provided. This is insufficient for **CLASSICAL** faculty signals in public content.
- Parents & Community: There is no explicit public articulation of parents as co-teachers or extensive parent-formation programs on the site excerpts; the public-facing materials do not demonstrate a strong partner-parents model. (Public materials excerpted do not provide explicit evidence for this category.)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- Public materials explicitly frame Oaks as Christ-centered with a goal to cultivate discernment of truth, goodness, and beauty. The mission states "Christ-centered, robust classical liberal arts education that ignites the joy of learning and fosters discernment of all things good, true, and beautiful." The "Our Deep Hope" emphasizes being rooted in Christ and pursuing truth.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive signals found: truth, goodness, beauty; theology/theology-adjacent framing (implicit via “Christ-centered,” rooted in Christ); reverence for virtue and the moral order (drawn from the Christian framing and classical aims).
- Negative signals: not readily evident in public-facing material; no explicit secular-relativist signals detected in the site excerpts.
- Why this rating
- The school clearly leans into a transcendent moral realism via a Christian framework, aligning with the Classical School’s emphasis on objective truths and a sacred/aesthetic frame. The dominant public-material signals are supportive of a CLASSICAL orientation in the religious/metaphysical dimension.

Citations: The mission and deep-hope statements explicitly frame this orientation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize formation, virtue, and discernment of truth/goodness/beauty as central aims, consistent with the classical telos of human flourishing and virtue formation in a Christian framework. The mission and deep-hope language foreground virtue-formation and alignment with a transcendent order.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful, scholé (conceptually implied through the sense of contemplative formation in the classical frame).
- Negative keywords: not explicitly invoked; the site’s language is more aspirational than job/career oriented.
- Why this rating
- The school’s stated goals center on formation and the pursuit of a transcendent order (truth/goodness/beauty) rather than purely utilitarian job-preparation language, which aligns with Classical ideals.

Citations: Mission and deep-hope language; classical-education framing.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials consistently describe Oaks as delivering a “classical liberal arts education,” which is a hallmark of classic curricula, but explicit details of traditional classical curriculum components (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; extensive history integrated across disciplines) are not publicly enumerated in the site excerpts. This yields a partial classical signal rather than a complete classical-curriculum disclosure.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: classical liberal arts education; (implicit) virtues and the Great Conversation via classical framing; focus on discernment and beauty.
- Negative keywords present in the public materials: explicit lists of grammar/logical/rhetorical study, Great Books, or hard-cannonical components are not publicly enumerated on the site excerpts. The lexicon’s explicit curriculum items (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; Latin/Greek; Trivium/Quadrivium) are not visible on Oaks’ public pages. This reduces the curriculum’s CLASSICAL score.
- Why this rating
- The explicit curricular language is strong in saying “classical liberal arts,” but the absence of publicly documented Great Books study, tons of historic-canon readings, and explicit Trivium/Quadrivium or grammar/logic/rhetoric sequencing lowers the alignment to a full Classical curriculum.

Citations: Oaks site mission language; lack of explicit Great Books/grammar/logic rhetoric on public pages.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public-facing content does not explicitly describe the canonical classical pedagogies (Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/narration, chant, or the memory-work oriented practices). While the language of “classical liberal arts education” appears, explicit pedagogy terms (Socratic, seminar, recitation, memory-work) are not present in the available public excerpts. This absence points away from a clearly classical pedagogy signal.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators: some language about delight in learning and a classical frame, but no explicit classical pedagogical techniques.
- Negative indicators (from the classical rubric): explicit references to contemplative or memory-based pedagogy (scholé, chanting, recitation) are not found in the public content; there is no explicit Socratic dialogue or seminary framework described.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit public articulation of canonical classical teaching methods, the pedagogy appears, at best, not clearly classical and, more likely, not-classical in the public materials.

Citations: Public Oaks content; lack of explicit Pedagogy terms.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site includes a Faculty & Staff page, and leadership information, but there is no explicit public description of faculty as “living curriculum,” “mentors,” or “model teachers,” nor a public portrait of the ideal teacher in the classical sense. The absence of explicit language about faculty as living exemplars weakens the Classical-faculty signal.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords from the classical lexicon (e.g., “living curriculum,” “mentors,” “portrait of teacher,” “model teachers”) are not visibly present in the Oaks site’s public-facing materials (in the excerpts provided).
- Negative signals: not necessarily present in the site content; however, the absence of explicit classical-faculty language means the site does not strongly meet the criterion.
- Why this rating
- Public-facing materials do not demonstrate the classical-faculty signals (e.g., living curriculum, mentor-modeling, or teacher formation) in the way the Classical framework expects.

Citations: Faculty & Staff page exists; content does not reveal classical-faculty language.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The Oaks site excerpts do not present explicit language about partnership with families as co-teachers, nor parent-formation programs or open-campus visitation norms. The explicit parent-partner language found in classical-education resources (as in the Six Essential Elements doc and ICE Pamphlet) is not visibly mirrored on Oaks’ public pages.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive signals in the classical lexicon include “partnership with families,” “parent formation,” “open campus,” and “parents as co-educators.” These do not appear in the public Oaks content in the excerpts above.
- Negative signals: the absence itself can be read as not meeting the category’s strong public signals.
- Why this rating
- Lacking explicit public-facing evidence of parent-teacher partnership and parent-formation activities, the school does not meet the Parents & Community criteria as strongly as required by classical templates.

Citations: Public materials do not show explicit parent-partnership framing; Six Essential Elements and ICE Pamphlet provide the normative expectations.

Aggregate Assessment

- Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL
- Rationale: The school demonstrates a Christian classical ethos and a stated aim of a classical liberal arts education, which aligns with two of the six categories (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose & Goal). However, public-facing curricular detail (e.g., Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium; grammar/logic/rhetoric), explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic/Scholé/memory-based work), and explicit faculty and parent-community commitments as described by classical standards are not clearly evidenced in the site excerpts provided. The combination of strong religious framing with partial classical curriculum and pedagogy signals yields a NOT CLASSICAL overall rating.

Citations: Evidence of Christ-centered mission and virtue/true/beauty framing.

What Would Move the Needle

- If Oaks Classical Academy aims to achieve a CLASSICAL rating, publicly document and implement the following:
- Curriculum: publicly articulate a Trivium/Quadrivium sequence, include explicit Great Books or canonical texts, and identify explicit emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric across grade bands. Display a clear map showing linear progression from grammar/recitation to rhetoric and logic, with integration of Great Books where appropriate. Include explicit history across the curriculum and attention to Western civilization as part of the classical canon.
- Pedagogy: publish explicit references to Socratic seminars or other classical discussion formats (e.g., scholé), recitation/memory work, and daily or weekly contemplative elements aligned with scholé.
- Faculty: articulate the living-curriculum concept, with teacher mentors modeling classical virtues and pedagogy; publish a “portrait of a teacher” and a “core-competencies/character” profile for faculty.
- Parents & Community: formalize a partnership with families as co-educators, offer parent-formation programs, book studies, and opportunities for parent involvement in classroom life; welcome parent visits and cultivate a family-centric classical culture.
- Theology integration: continue and more explicitly connect theology with classical method, ensuring ongoing integration across disciplines (as suggested by Christian classical education resources).
- These changes would move the school toward a FULL CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Citations for recommendations: Guidance and rationale drawn from classical-education sources that emphasize Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, living-curriculum, and parent partnership. See the public-education lexicon of Classical Elements and the ICE/Statement materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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